

READING PASSAGE 2

Globalisation and Its Effects on Labour Markets

A In recent years, globalisation and its effects on labour markets has attracted considerable attention from both the academic community and the general public. This growing interest reflects a broader recognition of the importance of this topic for understanding some of the most pressing challenges facing contemporary society.

B Historically, scholarly understanding of this topic was limited by both theoretical frameworks and available methodologies. Early researchers operated within relatively narrow conceptual boundaries, and their findings, while groundbreaking for their time, often failed to capture the full complexity of the phenomena they sought to explain. The development of new research tools and analytical techniques in the latter half of the twentieth century fundamentally transformed the landscape, enabling scholars to investigate questions that had previously been considered beyond the reach of empirical inquiry.

C The mechanisms underlying these phenomena operate at multiple levels of analysis, from the micro-level of individual decision-making to the macro-level of institutional and structural change. At the individual level, cognitive processes, emotional responses, and social influences shape the choices that people make. At the organisational level, formal rules, informal norms, and power dynamics govern collective action. At the societal level, historical legacies, cultural values, and political structures create the broad context within which lower-level processes unfold.

D Case studies from diverse geographical and cultural settings provide compelling illustrations of these dynamics in action. In one particularly well-documented example, researchers tracked developments over a fifteen-year period in a setting that offered a natural experiment in the effects of policy change. The introduction of a new regulatory framework produced a cascade of adaptations that rippled through the entire system, generating outcomes that both confirmed theoretical predictions and revealed previously unrecognised complexities.

E The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

F The implications of this body of research extend well beyond the academy. As societies grapple with increasingly complex challenges, the insights generated by scholarly inquiry in this domain have the potential to inform more effective and equitable policy responses. Realising this potential, however, will require sustained investment in both fundamental research and the translational infrastructure needed to convert knowledge into action.

G In conclusion, the study of globalisation and its effects on labour markets represents a vital and dynamic area of contemporary research. The progress that has been made in understanding the key mechanisms and dynamics provides a solid foundation for both further scholarly inquiry and practical application. The challenges that remain should be seen not as reasons for discouragement but as opportunities for continued intellectual growth and social contribution.

Question 1

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

1 What finding emerged from the landmark study discussed in the passage?

- A. inconsistent results across cultures
- B. a consistent pattern across diverse contexts
- C. no measurable effects
- D. effects limited to Western countries

Question 2

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

2 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

Question 3

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

3 According to the passage, what is one of the key factors identified by researchers?

- A. minimal impact
- B. creating underlying conditions for action
- C. determining individual choices directly
- D. irrelevant to outcomes

Question 4

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

4 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.

Question 5

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

5 What does the passage identify as a significant challenge to current understanding?

- A. pessimism about the future
- B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
- C. complete certainty about outcomes
- D. indifference to practical applications

Question 6

Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.

6 Researchers used data from more than _____ countries in the landmark study.

Questions 7–8

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 7 What finding emerged from the landmark study discussed in the passage?
- A. weak effects across studies
 - B. moderate to large effect sizes with consistency
 - C. contradictory findings
 - D. results only in specific populations
- 8 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. excessive funding
 - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
 - C. public interest
 - D. international collaboration

Question 9

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

- 9 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and _____.

Question 10

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write **TRUE** if the statement agrees with the information

Write **FALSE** if the statement contradicts the information

Write **NOT GIVEN** if there is no information on this

- 10 The author believes that all research questions in this field have been answered.

Questions 11–12

Complete the sentences below. Choose **NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

- 11 Dynamic _____ processes can amplify or dampen initial effects in complex systems.
- 12 The landmark study analysed data spanning a period of _____ years.

Question 13

Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?

Write **TRUE** if the statement agrees with the information

Write **FALSE** if the statement contradicts the information

Write **NOT GIVEN** if there is no information on this

13 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.